

Chapter 16 — Daivāsura-Sampad Yoga

दैवासुरसम्पद्विभागयोगः : దైవాసురసంపద్విభాగయోగము

"Divine & Demonic Natures" · 24 verses · The ethics of liberation

Chapter 16 makes a sharp ethical distinction. There are two basic tendencies operating in every human being: the **daivī sampad** (divine endowment) and the **āsuri sampad** (demonic endowment). One leads toward liberation, the other toward bondage. The chapter is both a self-examination mirror and a warning: **character matters**. Spiritual practice without ethics is hollow. Real progress requires cultivating the divine qualities (fearlessness, truthfulness, compassion, humility, freedom from anger) and rooting out the demonic ones (arrogance, hypocrisy, lust, anger, greed).

Essential verses of Chapter 16

BG 16.1-3 The 26 divine qualities — the daivī sampad

अभयं सत्त्वसंशुद्धिर्ज्ञानयोगव्यवस्थितिः ।
दानं दमश्च यज्ञश्च स्वाध्यायस्तप आर्जवम् ॥
अहिंसा सत्यमक्रोधस्त्यागः शान्तिरपैशुनम् ।
दया भूतेष्वलोलुप्त्वं मार्दवं ह्रीरचापलम् ॥
तेजः क्षमा धृतिः शौचमद्रोहो नातिमानिता ।
भवन्ति सम्पदं दैवीमभिजातस्य भारत ॥

abhayaṁ sattva-saṁśuddhir jñāna-yoga-vyavasthitiḥ |
dānaṁ damaś ca yajñaś ca svādhyāyas tapa ārjavam |
ahimsā satyam akrodhas tyāgaḥ śāntir apaiśunam |
dayā bhūteṣv aloluptvaṁ mārdavaṁ hrīr acāpalam |
tejaḥ kṣamā dhṛtiḥ śaucam adroho nāti-mānitā |
bhavanti sampadaṁ daivīm abhijātasya bhārata |

"Fearlessness, purity of mind, steadfastness in knowledge and yoga, charity, self-restraint, sacrifice, study, austerity, uprightness; non-violence, truth, freedom from anger, renunciation, peacefulness, no slander, compassion for beings, freedom from greed, gentleness, modesty, steadiness; vigor, forgiveness, fortitude, purity, freedom from malice, no excessive pride — these belong to one born with the divine endowment, O Bhārata."

Word-by-Word — Key terms from 16.1-3

IAST	संस्कृत	प्रारम्भिक	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>abhayaṁ</i>	अभयम्	అభయమ్	a-BHA-yam	fearlessness
<i>sattva-saṁśuddhiḥ</i>	सत्त्वसंशुद्धिः	సత్త్వసంశుద్ధిః	SAT-tva-sam-SHUD-dhiḥ	purity of mind / heart
<i>dānam</i>	दानम्	దానమ్	DAA-nam	charity, giving
<i>damaḥ</i>	दमः	దమః	DA-mah	self-restraint, sense-control
<i>svādhyāyaḥ</i>	स्वाध्यायः	స్వాధ్యాయః	SVAA-dhyaa-yah	scripture study, self-study
<i>ārjavam</i>	आर्जवम्	ఆర్జవమ్	AAR-ja-vam	uprightness, straightforwardness
<i>ahimsā</i>	अहिंसा	అహింసా	a-HIM-saa	non-violence, harmlessness
<i>satyam</i>	सत्यम्	సత్యమ్	SAT-yam	truth, truthfulness
<i>akrodhaḥ</i>	अक्रोधः	అక్రోధః	a-KRO-dhah	freedom from anger
<i>dayā bhūteṣu</i>	दया भूतेषु	దయా భూతేషు	da-YAA bhoo-TE-shu	compassion toward beings
<i>mārdavam</i>	मार्दवम्	మార్దవమ్	MAAR-da-vam	gentleness

IAST	संस्कृत	తెలుగు	PRONUNCIATION	MEANING
<i>hrīṭi</i>	ह्रीः	హ్రీః	hreeh	modesty, shame at doing wrong
<i>kṣamā</i>	क्षमा	క్షమా	ksha-MAA	forgiveness, patience
<i>dhṛtiḥ</i>	धृतिः	ధృతిః	DHRI-tih	fortitude, firmness
<i>adrohaḥ</i>	अद्रोहः	అద్రోహః	a-DRO-hah	absence of malice
<i>nāti-mānitā</i>	नातिमानिता	నాతిమానితా	naa-ti-maa-ni-TAA	absence of excessive pride

BG 16.21 □ *The three gates of hell — abandon them*

त्रिविधं नरकस्येदं द्वारं नाशनमात्मनः ।

कामः क्रोधस्तथा लोभस्तस्मादेतत्त्रयं त्यजेत् ॥ १६.२१ ॥

త్రివిధం నరకస్యేదం ద్వారం నాశనమాత్మనః ।

కామః క్రోధస్తథా లోభస్తస్మాదేతత్త్రయం త్యజేత్ ॥ ౧౬.౨౧ ॥

tri-vidhaṁ narakasyedaṁ dvāraṁ nāśanam ātmanaḥ |

kāmaḥ krodhas tathā lobhas tasmād etat trayaṁ tyajet ||

"Threefold is the gate of this hell, the destroyer of the self:

lust (*kāma*), anger (*krodha*), and greed (*lobha*).

Therefore, one should abandon these three."

The Gītā's most concise diagnosis of self-ruin.

□ Essential take-away of Chapter 16

Spirituality without ethics is a fraud.

All the meditation, knowledge, and devotion in the world will not save someone whose daily life is ruled by lust, anger, and greed. Conversely, even a beginner who cultivates fearlessness, truth, and compassion is already on the divine path.

Use this chapter as a **mirror**. Where do you find yourself today on the spectrum between **daivī** and **āsuri**? And then — without self-condemnation — water the divine seeds and starve the demonic ones.